

SURVEILLANCE.
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Surveillance technology pressures society to compromise human rights for the illusion of protection, posing significant ethical challenges. Distrust grows between the authorities and people as monitoring technologies advance and apply to public spaces. The challenge of trust tears away fundamental liberties, and the ethical implications of surveillance necessitate the question of how it impacts individualistic principles. Is there a balance between surveilling the public and providing safety, or does increased monitoring result in greater control and diminished freedom?

INTRODUCTION .



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Initial research surroundingsurveillance is examined, and a few themes within the topics are selected for further exploration. The independent study focuses on ethical questions, imbalance of power, and body autonomy to talk about surveillance systems present in society. Readings, films, and theories are studied to create a visual collection of images to depict these complex themes.

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HISTORY OF SURVEILLANCE.



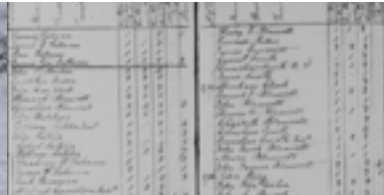
1700s

Latern Laws
NYC required Black, mixed-race & Indigenous enslaved individuals to carry a latern.



1789

U.S. Constitution
Protects the rights of the people.



1790

First Census
Data based on gender, color, identity among U.S. citizens over the age of 16.



1798

Alien and Sedition Acts
Allowed for any foreigner from the country that the U.S. was at war at, to be deported.



1819

Slave Patrols
South Carolina's General Assembly required 18+ white men to be slave patrols, to watch over slaves.



1864

California Wiretapping Law
Prohibits wiretapping telegraphs.



1895

Police Wiretapping
The first wiretapping by the police happened in New York. They secretly would wiretap for years after the approval of the Mayor.



1896

National Bureau of Identification
Records of information regarding criminals, used by the police.



1908

Bureau of Investigation
The increase in crime in the city led to the establishment of the Federal Bureau of Investigation.



1916

New York Police Wiretapping Scandal
Police were tapping hundreds of phones a year to track criminals & suppress labor activism.



1917

The Espionage Act
Attempt to prohibit war crimes by collecting photos, blueprints, or any information that could be used against the U.S.



1919 - 1920

The Palmer Raids and Red Scare
Attempt to arrest foreign anarchist, communists, and radical leftists.



1924

National Fingerprint Database
A National Fingerprint Database is created by the FBI & became the main method of identification in the U.S.



1925

Panopticon in the US
In Illinois, the first "round house" or panopticon is designed, allowing guards to watch prisoners without them knowing.



1928

Olmsted v. United States
The case decided on the constitutionality of police wiretapping. The court decided unwarrant wiretapping is allowed.



1930s

La Follette Civil Liberties Committee
The committee founded an abuse of wiretapping among corporations.



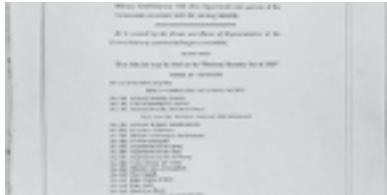
1938

Un-American Activities Committee
The committee investigated disloyalty and rebellion from anyone who may have had ties to communism.



1939

Operation SHAMROCK
The operation started during WWII to monitor radio & wire communication regarding foreign agents/ government.



1947
The National Security Act of 1947
 The act established the National Security Council (NSC) and Central Intelligence Agency (CIA).



1952
National Security Agency
 The National Security Agency (NSA) is established under the Secretary of Defense.



1967
Supreme Court Cases
 The Fourth Amendment protects citizens from the government's power to access their information without consent.



1968
Wiretap Statute
 Mandates the requirement for probable cause and individual warrants.



1973
Nixon's Enemy List
 The Watergate hearings exposed Nixon's Enemy List to exploit opposing politicians.



1978
Foreign Intelligence Surveillance Act
 The act established procedure for electronic surveillance and foreign information collection.



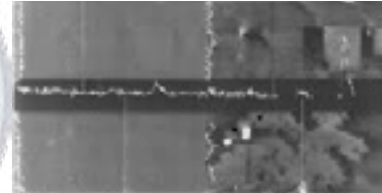
1981
Executive Order 12333
 All 17 United States intelligence organizations can collect information about citizens and foreign nationals abroad.



1986
Electronic Communications Privacy Act
 The act adds more restrictions on what the government can wiretap on telephone calls.



1994
Communication Assistance for Law Enforcement Act
 Network companies are enforced to redesign their software for the ease of the government's wiretaps.



2001
Kyllo v. United States
 It was unlawful and against the Fourth Amendment to aim a thermal-imaging device at a private home from a public street without a warrant.



2001
USA PATRIOT Act
 Uniting and Strengthening America by Providing Appropriate Tools Required to Intercept and Obstruct Terrorism (USA PATRIOT) Act.



2003
Room 641A
 Room 641A is an AT&T telecommunications interception facility. It monitored internet activity globally (warrantlessly).



2008
Section 702
 The section is part of the Foreign Intelligence Surveillance Act (FISA), authorizing the U.S. to collect foreign intelligence globally.



2012
United States v. Jones
 The case states using (GPS) tracking devices without a warrant violated the Fourth Amendment and was unconstitutional.



2013
Snowden Revelations
 NSA's information regarding their surveillance program is leaked by Edward Snowden. It invaded their users' privacy.



2014
Riley v. California
 The case ruled that the warrantless search and seizure of the digital contents of a cell phone during an arrest is unconstitutional.



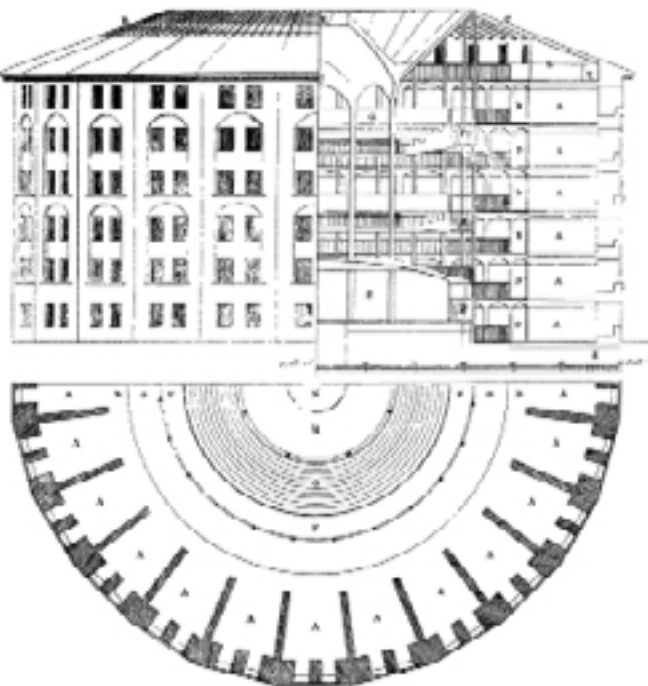
2015
USA FREEDOM Act
 The new act replaced the USA PATRIOT Act. It limits the government from gathering data following the Snowden Revelations.



2018
Carpenter v. United States
 The case found that the use of historical cell-site location information (CSLI) without a warrant violates the Fourth Amendment.

Jeremy Bentham envisioned the concept of the panopticon in 1735. It is designed with a round overwatch from a tower in the center. It warrants a few guards to watch the prisoners.

The authority has the power to see and choose when these prisoners are being watched. The behavior at the panopticon is a result of the authority and the fear of being watched. There is fear only act in the panopticon is the controller of the space.



The panopticon is a form of surveillance where the prisoners are always being watched, as if they cannot see if they are being watched. The "openness" of the space allows the controller to see the prisoners at any time.

PANOPTICON.

Jeremy Bentham's design concept for the panopticon can be argued to be inhumane. The inbuilt system of control oppresses the captives occupying the space and harms their well-being. Prisoners will be programmed to only act in ways to satisfy the controller - giving up autonomy over their bodies. The harsh ideation of the panopticon is used as a metaphor by philosopher Micheal Foucault to depict the control the government has over its people's behavior.

JEREMY BENTHAM.



SONG DO CITY, SOUTH KOREA.

Song Do City in South Korea is near Incheon and developed to be the country's first smart city. It will serve as a large transportation hub for foreign and domestic travelers while being a high-tech city with no overcrowding or pollution to be as sustainable as possible. It is predicted to be the center of Korea's economy once it is finished to accommodate what Seoul lacks. It is ongoing construction and is projected to open in 2025. Technology will be integrated with the city - many houses will be able to operate through cell phones for heating/cooling, lighting, etc. CCTV's will be located as in many places as possible. The new city will provide 33,000 new residents and jobs with more than half of fewer emissions than development its size. Song Do will act as a utopia for the economy and technological growth of Korea, and be a precedent for future smart cities.

BIO.
POLITICS.
BIOPOLITICS.

BIO.
POLITICS.
BIOPOLITICS.

"Disciplinarity had traced a transformation from the naked violence of visible punishment to a form of correctional techniques that assembled around the body, and generated a form of political technology that produced a soul as a new object of knowledge – the soul, which in this sense also becomes the 'prison of the body.' Discipline, Foucault famously says, is not primarily about prohibiting (just as power in a more general sense is not essentially repressive), but works in terms of a positive organization of space and time, a partition and creation of segmented unities, and a breaking down and analysis of movements down to their smallest detail (as in military exercise, control of body postures in school, and so forth). Space, time, and bodies are parceled up, and then assembled so as to become parts of larger and more efficient unities. (p.49, D.H)"

BIOPOLITICS.

Power, or political technology, has subconsciously shaped and formed society. People are programmed by their body language; what is deemed acceptable versus unacceptable, or polite or impolite? The naked violence of discipline has influenced society's movement to the little details. When everyone as an individual is fed knowledge by authority, it allows for unity when they come together. A unit of people becomes efficient when their movements complement each other, not work against each other. The flow and productivity are convenient to those in power – when the people are "in order," everything stays in order. The power of the government influences one's subconscious actions, and it is political; authority manages and regulates the bodies of the population.

CONCEPTUALIZED BY MICHEL FOUCAULT.

CHARLIE CHAPLIN – MODERN TIMES.



Charlie is a factory worker, and his duty is to twist the screws of the object on the conveyor belt tight. He has to keep up with the pace of the belt, and do a proper job since his coworkers also have their tasks down the line that relies on his job.

He is told to take a break and hands off his wrenches to another coworker. His body has become programmed to the motion of tightening the screws; even when he gives his tool away, his body is still mimicking the action of his work.



During his break, he smokes and relaxes (he is no longer motioning to tighten the screw), but in the back of his mind, he feels watched by his boss. The moment he thought about how his boss would scold him to get back to work, he knew his break was over.

FACTORY WORK / SCENE (1936).



Charlie's body has become used to seeing everyday things and associating them with work. He is not working but uses the wrench to "screw" his coworker's nose.



He sees buttons on a woman's dress and associates it with screws. He chases her down with wrenches. His body language begins to clearly show the lack of control Charlie has over his actions.

Another woman has similar buttons on her top and Charlie begins to go after her. These scenes depict how his body has become programmed to move due to working at the factory, despite if there is no correlation to work.



COGNITIVE ARCHITECTURE.

Cognitive Architecture: From Bio-Politics to Noo-Politics ; Architecture & Mind in the Age of Communication and Information is a collection of journals providing different perspectives regarding cognitive architecture. The book explores the topic of surveillance – from body autonomy, biopolitics, monitoring technologies, and theories. These readings inspire the visuals to follow in the series / fragment / collection.

Crandall, Jordan.
"Movement, Agency, and
Sensing: A Performative
Theory of the Event."
Cognitive Architecture:
From Bio-Politics
to Noo-Politics ;
Architecture & Mind in
the Age of Communication
and Information, 010
Publishers, 2010.

"A pattern is revealed, derived from
the past, and this demonstrates a
likelihood, a propensity, for what
could happen today. This pattern
might be stabilized, made operational
in a formula, but this retains the
potential to be destabilized, since
new factors can always be introduced
that may modify it. The aim is not for
rigidity but provisional stability -
something stable enough to do the
job (p. 403, J.C)."

READING RESPONSES.

Surveillance has evolved, it is not
a new system or form of technology.
Technology has allowed patterns to
be used as a way to predict; although
it is not a fixed system and allows
for changes, it provides a constant
variable. These patterns allow for
the system to evolve and adapt to
societal changes, to monitor whatever
authorities want to monitor.
Artificial intelligence is widely
talked about today, and it is a tool
that thrives and works off patterns.
Everything AI generates is derived
from an existing source. Technology
advancement can only go further
as more and more testing with the
increase in sources being pushed.
These models do not seek perfection
but validation - the software may be
imperfect as long as it works.

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"Who knows why people do what
they do? The point is they do it,
and we can track and measure it
with unprecedented fidelity. With
enough data, the numbers speak for
themselves. (p. 405, J.C)."

READING RESPONSES.

People are numbers gathered from
surveillance technologies and imputed
in calculations to predict behavior.
Despite the cold objectification of
humans and exploitation for data,
the justification behind gathering
these unethical numbers does not
prevent authorities from monitoring
the population to mine data. There
is no way to fully stop authority's
monitorization, and oftentimes the
people are already programmed. The
system establishes how society
operates, and disruption is frowned
upon, hence why these numbers, or
people, formulate data correlating
with similar information. The
question of whether or not there
is truly an authentic self comes
to light, as the answer would be
no if looking at the data collected
in relation to human behavior. What
does authenticity mean? Can society
be liberated without the pressure of
being watched?

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and Information, 010
Publishers, 2010.

"Networking and sensor technologies
are used by law enforcement, the
military, and national security.
They are incorporated into body-
monitoring systems, sometimes via
implants, in the military and medical
spheres where they participate
in the translation of corporeal
information (heart rate, hormone
levels, temperature) into data,
'facilitating hyper-individualized
control and the commodification of
life functions (p. 408, J.C)."

READING RESPONSES.

Authoritative organizations will
utilize surveillance technology to
monitor the population as a form of
control. Not only is society being
watched, everyone is a piece of data
that is being collected through their
bodies. It brings up the question of
whether or not people are aware and
if they can consent to their bodies
being examined through surveillance
systems to gather numbers for the
benefit of authoritative figures.
There are ethical implications about
whether or not these powerful groups
are exploiting innocent people with
ill intent.

Although may feel inhumane to say
surveillance objectifies people to
numbers, think about cell phones.
The device is commonly used, yet
it is hardly ever seen as a tool
to objectively humans. Still, it
incorporates tracking technology,
web browsing collection, and
information regarding the user's
health (heart rate monitor, step
counter, sleep cycle analysis, etc.).
Cell phones are carried and used on
a daily basis, but how many users
would consent to allow all these
built-in surveillance technologies
to collect data? How many users are
fully aware of what such a seemingly
mundane tool is truly capable of?

Crandall, Jordan.
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"On the surface this technology might
seem contradictory. As a 'proactive'
tool, it reaches for the event, yet
it also seeks to prevent this event
from occurring. Yet the event, too,
is irrefutable: as an attention-worthy
incident, a matter of fascination or
concern, it is at once a violation
and an affirmation. The event is a
disruptive occurrence, an exception,
a deviation from the established
norm - a violent agitation of the
sanctity of the default (p. 403,
J.C)."

READING RESPONSES.

Events are not static; they are
dynamic processes with emergent
and sudden interactions between
individuals and their environments.
The progression of humans as a species
may seem stable and predictable, but
there may be an occurrence to disrupt
the flow without any logic behind
it (known as the event theory).
Technology development arises at
an unpredictable rate hence a spike
of growth in monitoring systems,
but the advancement surpasses the
population's ability to comprehend
the evolution. Technology curates
convenience - the establishment
of doorbell cameras, for example,
ensures residents can monitor the
front yard without moving an inch
away from a phone screen. Although
doorbell cameras are quite common
today, ten to fifteen years ago,
these technologies did not exist or
were nowhere to be as developed as
they are now. However, despite the
new protection the system provides,
there is a risk of hackers accessing
the cameras, and many users do not
understand or know about technological
vulnerabilities. It showcases the
violation the technology brings
since these surveillance system
hacks within private homes had been
unprecedented prior, but it is also
an affirmation since it is designed
as a tool to protect one's home.

SURVEILLANCE IN.

FILMS.



Critiques regarding surveillance in society come in numerous forms, one example being the film *Brazil* (1985), which showcases a tightly surveilled dystopian society." In *Brazil*, Sam Lowry—the protagonist—is a man who initially follows the everyday rules and expectations of society, but his dreams begin to intertwine with his reality. His actions begin to disrupt the flow of the mundane life, leading to chaos to unfold. From Sam's dreams about flying to running away from government officials, the film explores the critiques of a bureaucratic society to highlight the effect control has over individual freedom in a comedic sense.

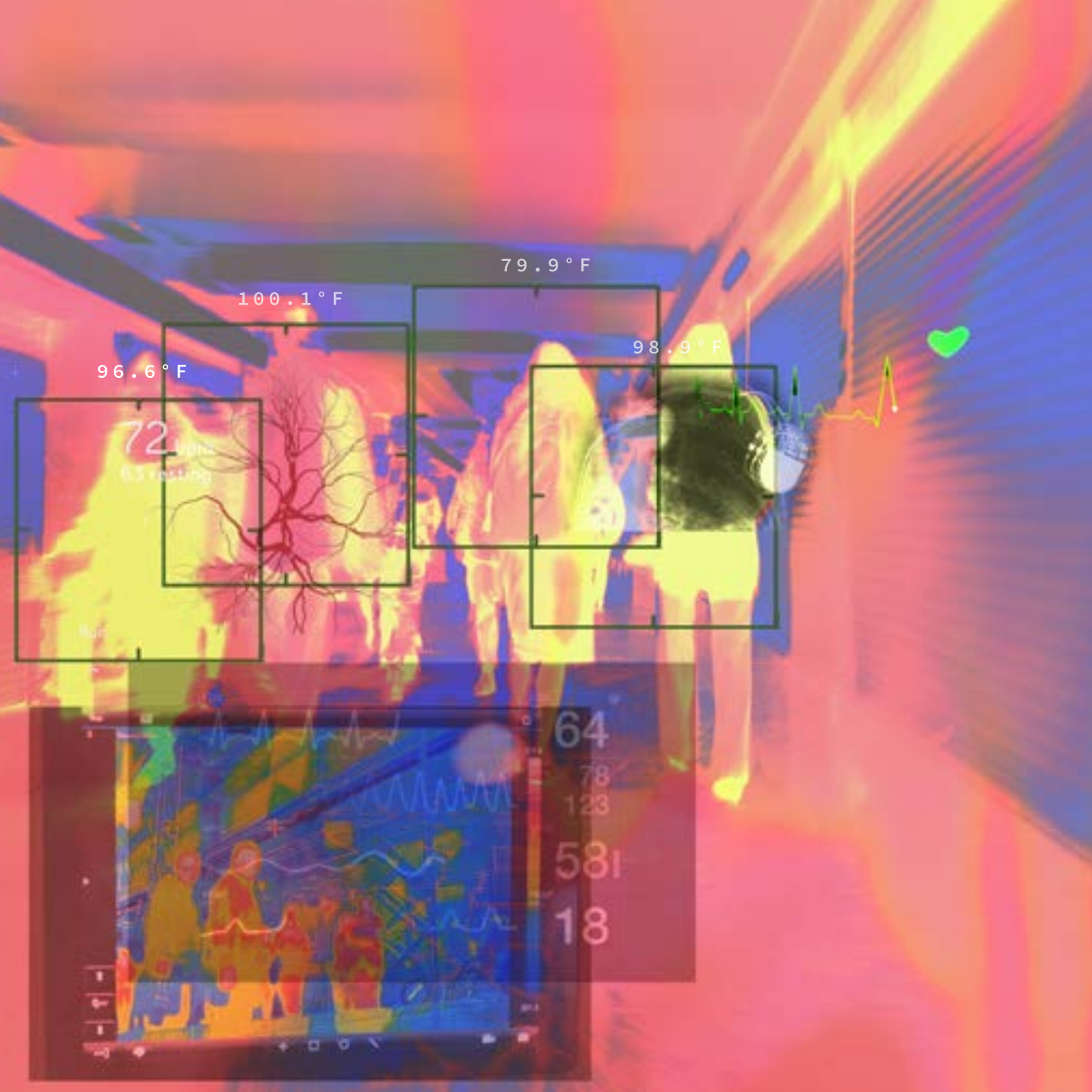
In a related setting *Blade Runner* (1982) is similarly set in a dystopian world. The protagonist is the Blade Runner who is designated to destroy "replicants," or technologically manmade beings who replicate the appearance of humans. Exploration of technology, especially artificial intelligence, is questioned but also proposes what being human truly means.

Lastly, *Minority Report* delves into the relationship between authorities protecting the population and the trade-off it comes with. The police department, pre-crimes, provides warrant arrests to be made to prevent future crimes through the help of psychic readers. Subsequently, viewing these films provides further perspective in a visual narrative form to question surveillance, what it means, its impacts, and how it threatens the autonomy of one's body.

Brazil (1985), Terry Gilliam

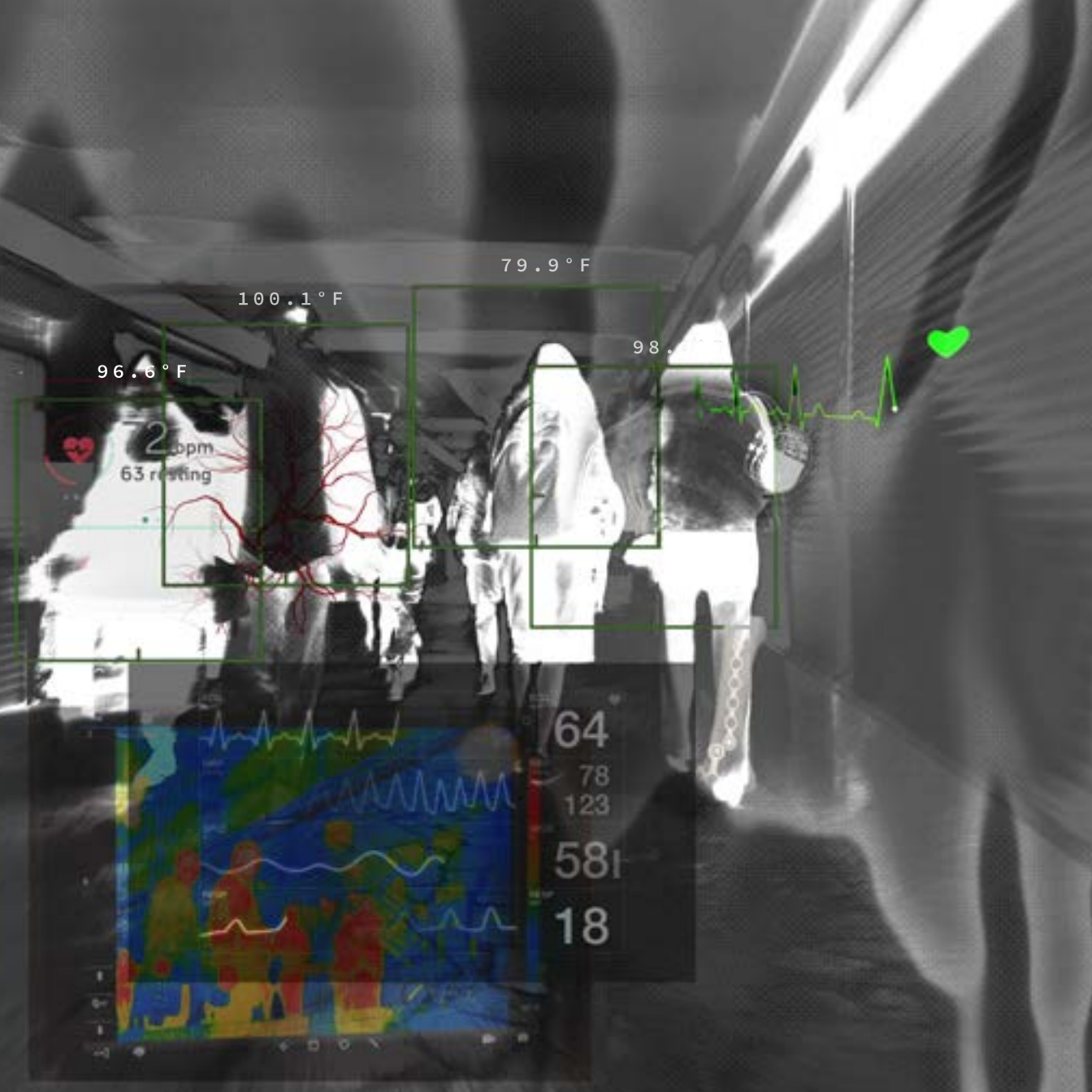
Blade Runner (1982), Ridley Scott

Minority Report, Steven Spielberg



People are objectified as numbers through the lens of surveillance technology to collect data. Technology doesn't see humans, only objects. Authorities utilize tracking technology to provide them with data collected by monitoring people. Cameras can detect one's body temperature, heart rate, etc. Many organizations process personal information to push products it detects the user may need/ desire, whether it is from what one may perceive as surveillance tools like thermal cameras or an everyday cell phone. Surveillance technologies objectify human beings and behavior to become data.

UNWARRENTED COLLECTION OF DATA .



ALTERNATIVE ART .

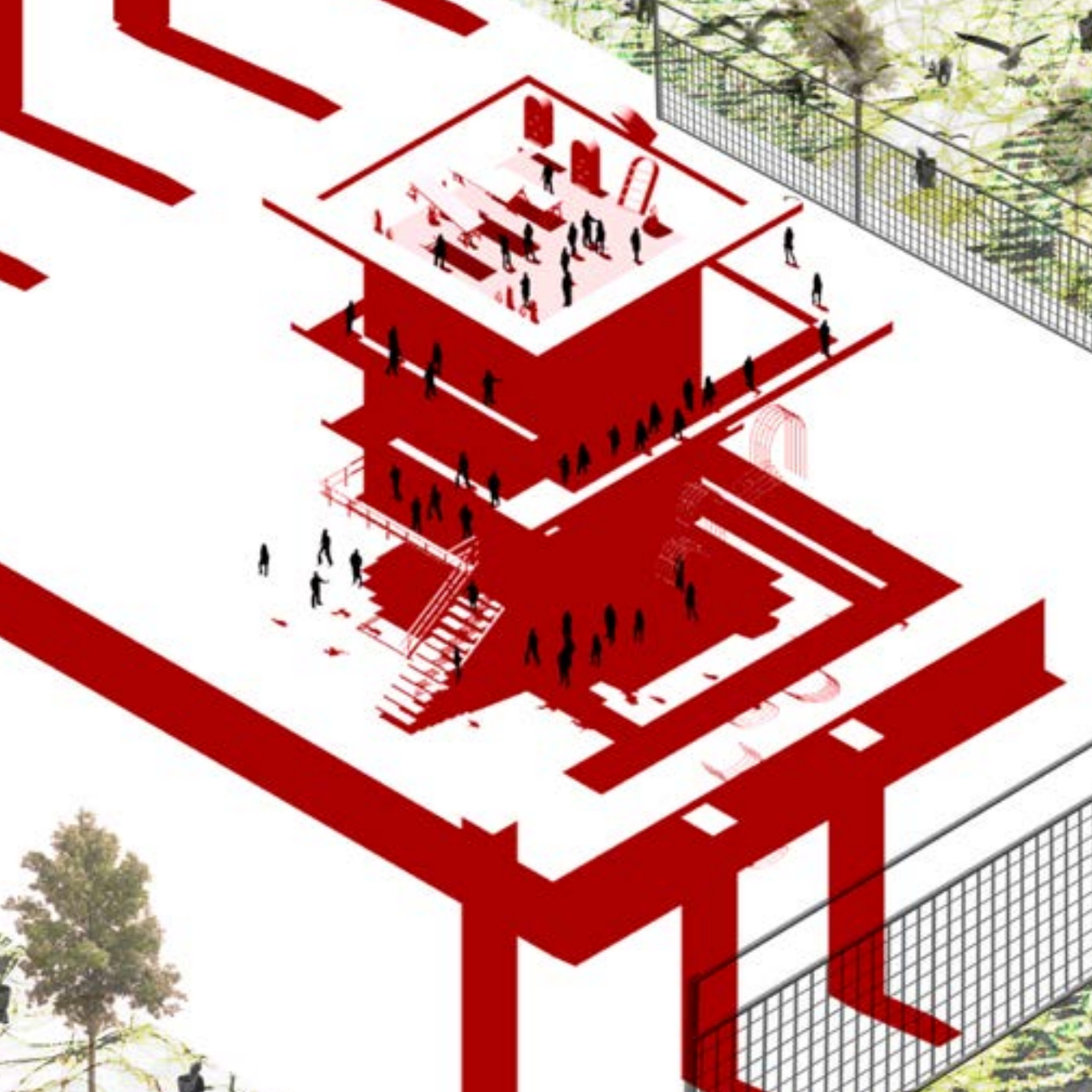
The alternative emphasizes what the camera is detecting/ information the system is gathering from those occupying the space.

UNWARRENTED COLLECTION OF DATA .



The walls are parametrically designed using an attractors system, hence the gradient of the openings getting smaller in the center. The technology is used as a tool to protect the people behind the walls from cameras (where there is no opening, the wall is closed to protect users), but even so, there is a constant fear of being surveilled. Parametrics can also create design patterns to play with the camera - to create an illusion and "break" the camera.

DISRUPTING CAMERA ACTIVITY .



The structure is highly developed and contrasts with the underdevelopment of the surrounding site. The isolating building attracts people to come to explore, meanwhile confusing them to become lost yet curious about the new place. The longer one is there, the realization of everything being present hits, and there becomes no desire to leave. The spatial qualities are far advanced and convenient for those occupying the place. The owner of the building gains complete control over the autonomy of the users to trap them to stay, occupy and evolve the space - almost acting as a city.

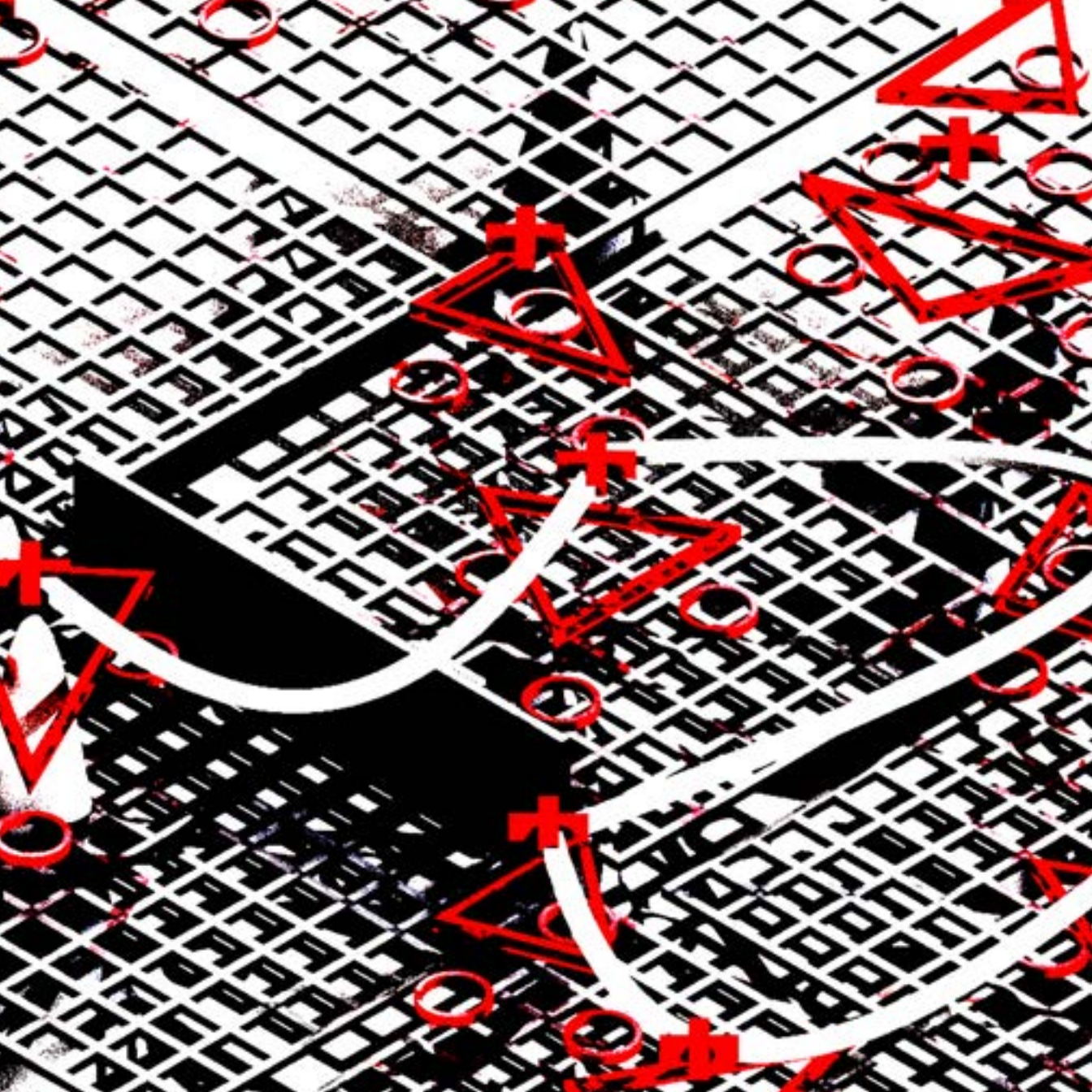
HYPERSPACE .

the tawdry and commercial sign-system of the surrounding city, but rather, on the contrary, seek to speak that very language, using its lexicon and syntax as that has been emblematically 'learned from Las Vegas'.

On the first of these counts, Portman's *Bonaventura* fully confirms the claim: it is a popular building, visited with enthusiasm by locals and tourists alike (although Portman's other buildings are even more successful in this respect). The populist insertion into the city fabric is, however, another matter, and it is with this that we will begin. There are three entrances to the *Bonaventura*, one from Figueroa, and the other two by way of elevated gardens on the other side of the hotel, which is built into the remaining slope of the former Beacon Hill. None of these is anything like the old hotel marquee, or the monumental porte-cochère with which the sumptuous buildings of yesteryear were wont to stage your passage from city street to the older interior. The entryways of the *Bonaventura* are as it were lateral and rather backdoor affairs: the gardens in the back admit you to the sixth floor of the towers, and even there you must walk down one flight to find the elevator by which you gain access to the lobby. Meanwhile, what one is still tempted to think of as the front entry, on Figueroa, admits you, baggage and all, onto the second-storey shopping balcony, from which you must take an escalator down to the main registration desk. More about these elevators and escalators in a moment. What I first want to suggest about these curiously unmarked ways-in is that they seem to have been imposed by some new category of closure governing the inner space of the hotel itself (and this over and above the material constraints under which Portman had to work). I believe that, with a certain number of other characteristic postmodern buildings, such as the *Beaubourg* in Paris, or the Eaton Centre in Toronto, the *Bonaventura* aspires to being a total space, a complete world, a kind of miniature city (and I would want to add that to this new total space corresponds a new collective practice, a new mode in which individuals move and congregate, something like the practice of a new and historically original kind of hyper-crowd). In this sense, then, ideally the mini-city of Portman's *Bonaventura* ought not to have entrances at all, since the entryway is always the seam that links the building to the rest of the city that surrounds it: for it does not wish to be a part of the city, but rather its equivalent and its replacement or substitute. That is, however, obviously not possible or practical, whence the deliberate downplaying and reduction of the entrance function to its bare minimum. But this disjunction from the surrounding city is very different from that of the great monuments of the International Style: there, the act of disjunction was violent, visible, and had a very real symbolic significance—as in Le Corbusier's great *palais* whose gesture radically separates the new Utopian space of the modern from the degraded and fallen city fabric which it thereby explicitly repudiates (although the gamble of the modern was that this new Utopian space, in the virulence of its *Novum*, would fan out and transform that eventually by the very power of its new spatial language). The *Bonaventura*, however, is content to 'let the fallen city fabric continue to be in its being' (to parody Heidegger); no further effects, no larger protopolitical Utopian transformation, is either expected or desired.



Fredric Jameson's *Postmodernism, or The Cultural Logic of Late Capitalism*, critiques the Bonaventura Hotel as a mini-city, a total space and world of its own, separate from the rest of society. The people inside begin to lose body autonomy and let the environment take control while consciously choosing to stay.



GPS systems are able to track one's location through the process of trilateration. One's location is determined based on three points, where known satellites are located and GPS systems find the position relative to these points. Tracking serves its purpose to allow others to know one's location for their safety, and locate nearby services, but carrying these devices allows one to be tracked at all times.

TRACKING .



Sovereignty is often associated with feeling protected. Authorities govern the space to operate it, and the people occupying serve as followers of the system. Protection by the authorities can be disguised as control – leading to isolation. Restriction comes with the power of control, and it alludes to the gradual feeling of losing body autonomy, and confining to the politics of the place.

SOVEREIGNTY .



When one's place of belonging is distorted, it leads to a sense of lostness. Authorities enjoy having full control over the perception the people have of the space the government establishes, but when these visions conflict, distrust is present. The hostility between the two exposes the bad and good, and congests at the perfect image the authority had once tried to create.

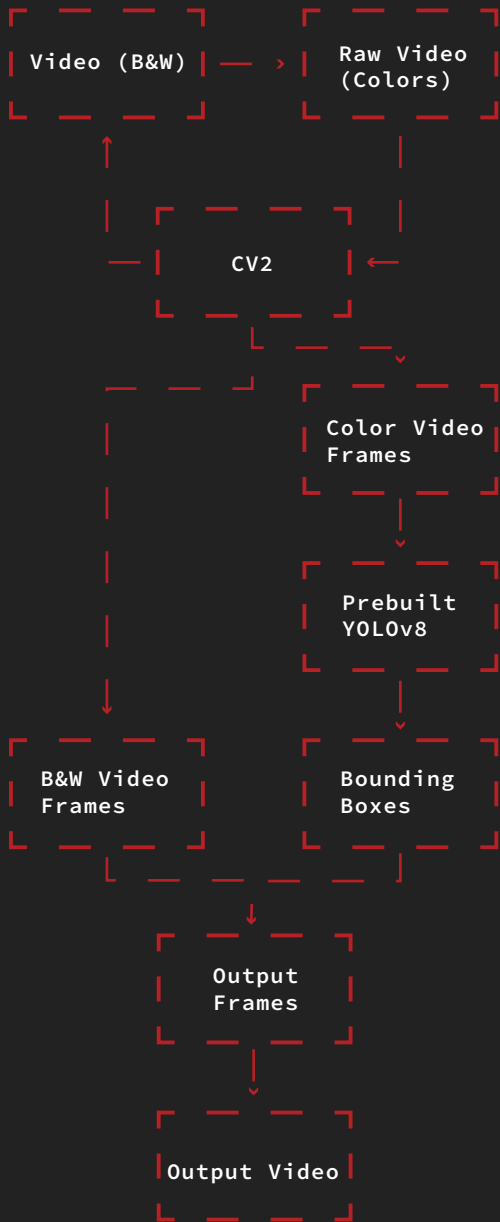
CONGESTED SPACE .



In collaboration with Cameron Mohne.

Using technology to create a surveillance tool showcases the reality of how terrifying computers are. The model behind the image is created by one who has little knowledge of coding. YOLOv8, an open-source Computer Vision (CV) recognition library, is downloaded and utilized in the model to allow for any video to be analyzed. Once the media is loaded in the code, each frame is scanned to detect faces. The code is simple and serves as a base for facial recognition, implying there is room to push and specify the model to obtain data.

APPLICATION + EXPERIMENT .



Video output to images

The figures on the left are a framework for how the model runs. The process revealed how scary technology can be – the model is made despite knowing very little code but works well enough to become a base for detailed any facial recognition software. YOLOv8 is just one library found, there are various other Computer Vision models YOLO has to detect objects, license plate numbers, etc. Initially, an original video was supposed to be used in the code but hypocritical enough, it felt invasive to record others and use it for content.

Seoul Walker. "Walking at Night in Seoul City ." YouTube, 19 Apr. 2024, <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aDSWbHSQ8Nk>. Accessed 1 Aug. 2024.

APPLICATION + EXPERIMENT .

